

STP + CUSTOMER PERSONA WORKSHEET

MBA Digital Marketing Activity | Complete for ONE product/service

Student instruction: Do not describe "everyone." Identify meaningful segments, select a target, and convert that target group into one realistic persona. Support important assumptions with evidence.

PROJECT DETAILS	YOUR RESPONSE
Company	The Pokémon Company (TPC)
Product / Service	Pokémon Trading Card Game (TCG) physical cards: booster packs, Elite Trainer Boxes, and singles
Team Members	Group 21
Market / Geography	India (metro and Tier-1 cities primarily)

1. PRODUCT SNAPSHOT

Question	Your Analysis
Customer problem solved	Gives fans of the Pokémon anime/games a physical, tradeable way to keep engaging with the franchise; fills the need for an affordable, collectible hobby that blends nostalgia, light strategy gameplay and social connection
Key benefits	Iconic, decades-old characters; the thrill of rarity/chase (holo, full-art, special-rare pulls); simple-to-learn two-player strategy gameplay; strong resale/collector value; a shared hobby for trading with friends, family or online communities
Price / price range	Booster pack ₹850–₹2,000; Elite Trainer Box ₹12,000–₹25,000+ (import-driven pricing); individual/graded rare singles from a few hundred rupees to several lakh for museum-grade cards
Where / how it is sold	No official Pokémon Company distributor in India; sold mainly through specialty importer websites (e.g., TCGVault, PokéTCG, TCG Republic Mumbai, Beyond Gaming, Magikart), a growing number of hobby/game stores in metro cities, and unofficial wholesale listings on marketplaces like IndiaMART; also resold via Instagram and WhatsApp
Major competitors	Other global TCGs sold in India like One Piece Card Game (Bandai), Yu-Gi-Oh! (Konami), Magic: The Gathering; also cheaper unlicensed local 'trading card' products (cricket, WWE-style) competing for the same pocket-money spend
Differentiator	Unmatched global brand recognition from a 30-year-old IP (anime, games, films) that no other card game in India can match; cross-generational appeal — parents who watched the anime on Cartoon Network/Hungama in the early 2000s, and their kids discovering it via Pokémon GO/TCG Pocket; the deepest global secondary/resale market of any TCG

2. SEGMENTATION — FIND THE GROUPS

Dimension	What to examine	Your key segment(s)
DEMOGRAPHIC	Age, gender, income, occupation, education, life stage	Children 8–14 (pocket-money buyers introduced via the anime/games); teens & young adults 15–24 (students, competitive players); millennials 25–35 (nostalgic collectors with disposable income)
GEOGRAPHIC	Country, region, city type, urban/rural, locality	Concentrated in metro and Tier-1 cities (Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi-NCR, Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai) with importer stores, hobby shops and TCG communities; minimal presence in Tier-2/3 towns and rural India due to the lack of official distribution
PSYCHOGRAPHIC	Lifestyle, values, personality, interests, aspirations	Nostalgia-driven pop-culture and anime fans; detail-oriented collectors who value rarity, art and provenance; competitive strategy-game enthusiasts; investors drawn to rising secondary-market values
BEHAVIOURAL	Usage, purchase, benefits sought, loyalty, motivation, price sensitivity	Heavy collectors who chase every new set; casual players who buy to play with friends/family; one-time gift buyers (parents/relatives); resellers/investors who grade and flip cards
WEBGRAPHIC	Platforms, search, content, devices, creators,	Instagram/YouTube unboxing and 'pull'

	communities, online buying	videos; WhatsApp and Discord trading/community groups; niche Shopify stores rather than large marketplaces; r/PokemonTCG and India-specific TCG Discords; Pokémon TCG Pocket app users who cross-buy physical cards
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Write 3–5 distinct segments you could potentially serve:

Segment	Who are they?	Why might they need this product?
1	Young collectors (8–14) — School-age kids in metro India introduced via the Pokémon anime, Pokémon GO or TCG Pocket; buy with parents' pocket money or receive cards as gifts	Want an affordable, tradeable hobby and social currency with friends who watch or play Pokémon
2	Nostalgic millennial collectors (25–35) — Working professionals in metro India who grew up watching the Pokémon anime on Cartoon Network/Hungama in the early 2000s and now have disposable income	Seek nostalgia, a display-worthy collection, and a hobby with genuine resale/investment value
3	Competitive teen/young-adult players (15–24) — Students and young professionals active in city TCG communities (e.g., India TCG Association, Bengaluru; WhatsApp/Discord groups) who play in local tournaments	Want a strategic, skill-based card game and a community/tournament scene to belong to
4	Reseller-investors — Collectors across age groups who buy sealed product to grade (PSA/CGC) and resell, active on Instagram and WhatsApp resale groups	See Pokémon cards as an appreciating collectible, especially around the 30th-anniversary (2026) hype cycle
5	Parent / gift buyers — Parents or relatives of Pokémon-fan children buying Elite Trainer Boxes or blister packs for birthdays and festivals	Want a screen-time alternative and a gift the child will value, without being TCG-literate themselves

3. TARGETING DECISION

Criterion	Segment 1	Segment 2	Segment 3
Market size / potential	Large potential pool of school-age kids, but low individual spend and parental gatekeeping	Smaller in absolute numbers but the highest average spend per buyer (ETBs, graded singles)	Medium; a small but steadily growing base in metro cities
Growth potential	High — helped by Pokémon GO/TCG Pocket cross-over and anime reruns on Indian streaming	High — fuelled by the global 30th-anniversary campaign (2026) and rising collector/resale culture	Medium-High — the organised tournament scene is expanding from a small base
Need / fit	Good fit for entry-level products (booster/blister packs); price-sensitive	Excellent fit — this segment is a core driver of India's premium-priced collector demand	Good fit for playable product lines; needs affordable singles, not only sealed product
Accessibility / digital reach	Reachable only indirectly, through parents; limited independent purchasing/payment access	Highly reachable — active on Instagram/YouTube, comfortable with online payment and imports	Reachable via WhatsApp/Discord communities, though these groups are still small and city-specific
Competition	High — competes with cheaper unlicensed cards, mobile games and other toys for pocket money	Moderate — competes with One Piece/Yu-Gi-Oh! collectors, but Pokémon's nostalgia is a strong lock-in	Moderate — Yu-Gi-Oh! has a loyal competitive base, but Pokémon's global tournament ecosystem is bigger
Profit potential	Lower — small basket sizes; only viable at volume	Highest — larger basket sizes (ETBs, graded cards) and lower price sensitivity	Medium — recurring deck-building purchases, but singles-heavy, lower-margin baskets
Strategic fit	Builds the long-term funnel, but is not well served today without an official distributor	Strongest fit with India's current import-led, niche specialty-retail reality	Supports long-term community and brand health, and future organised play in India

Selected primary target: Nostalgic millennial collectors (25–35) in metro India

Why this target? They have the highest disposable income and lowest price sensitivity, which matches India's import-driven, premium-priced retail reality; they are digitally reachable via Instagram/YouTube/community groups; and the global 30th-anniversary campaign (2026) gives an immediate reason for them to re-engage right now.

Targeting approach: ☐ Undifferentiated ☐ Differentiated ☒ Concentrated/Niche ☐ Micromarketing

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Persona → Journey → Positioning | Final synthesis

4. CUSTOMER PERSONA — TURN THE SEGMENT INTO A PERSON

Persona Attribute	Your Persona
Name / nickname	Rohan aka "The Nostalgic Collector"
Age / gender / location	29, male, Bengaluru
Occupation / income	Software engineer at a mid-size IT firm; approx. ₹14–18 LPA
Family / life stage	Single, lives independently or with a roommate; no children
Lifestyle	Fast-paced tech job; unwinds with anime, gaming and pop-culture conventions; active on Instagram and YouTube
Personality / values	Nostalgic and detail-oriented; enjoys organising and curating collections; values authenticity and provenance over sheer volume
Goals / aspirations	Complete the childhood-favourite set he collected as a kid; build a display-worthy collection; occasionally profit from rare pulls
Needs / problems	Wants a reliable way to buy authentic, correctly graded cards in India despite there being no official Pokémon Company presence
Frustrations / barriers	High import markups and customs delays; risk of counterfeit cards; no official Play!-Pokémon-style store network or events nearby
Purchase motivations	Nostalgia tied to the 30th-anniversary campaign, rarity/chase appeal, resale value, and sharing pulls online
Brand preferences	Trusts verified Indian importer stores (TCGVault, PokéTCG, TCG Republic Mumbai); prefers PSA/CGC-graded cards; follows official Pokémon channels and Indian TCG community creators

5. DIGITAL PERSONA

Digital Behaviour	Your Persona
Most-used platforms	Instagram, YouTube, WhatsApp groups, Discord
Search behaviour	Searches "buy Pokémon cards India", "authentic Pokémon cards", new set release dates, and price checks before buying
Content consumed	Unboxing/pull videos, set-review videos, "how to spot a fake" authentication guides
Creators / influencers followed	Indian TCG unboxing creators, global Pokémon-pull YouTubers, and local hobby-store Instagram pages
Online shopping behaviour	Buys via niche Shopify stores and WhatsApp Business catalogues; pre-orders new sets; occasionally imports directly from Japan/US sellers
Reviews / recommendations	Relies on Google reviews of the store and community vetting on Reddit/Discord before trusting a new seller
Preferred content format	Short-form video (Reels/Shorts) for hype and new drops; longer YouTube videos for deep-dive reviews and authentication
Preferred brand communication	Community-first channels — WhatsApp/Discord restock alerts, Instagram drop announcements

6. CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Stage	Customer thought / behaviour	Digital touchpoint	Brand opportunity
Awareness	Sees a nostalgia post or unboxing reel tied to the Pokémon 30th-anniversary campaign	Instagram/YouTube Reels, Pokémon Day content	Lean into nostalgia-driven, anniversary storytelling in content
Consideration	Searches for trustworthy Indian sellers and compares prices	Google search, importer-store Instagram pages, Reddit/Discord threads	Offer transparent authenticity guarantees and comparison content
Evaluation	Checks seller reviews and verifies authenticity before committing	Google reviews, Discord community feedback, YouTube pull-rate videos	Partner with trusted creators; display verified/authenticity badges
Purchase	Buys via the store website or a WhatsApp catalogue; pre-orders limited sets	Shopify checkout, WhatsApp Business ordering	Smooth checkout, pre-order alerts, bundle offers
Usage / Loyalty	Opens packs, grades and organises the collection, joins a local community	Discord servers, India TCG Association meet-ups/tournaments	Loyalty perks, community meet-ups, grading partnerships
Advocacy	Shares pulls on Instagram/YouTube and refers friends to a trusted seller	User-generated content, referral links/codes	Referral incentives; feature customer pulls; run UGC campaigns

7. POSITIONING

Complete the statement:

For nostalgic millennial collectors and pop-culture fans in urban India, Pokémon TradingCardGame is the authentic, globally iconic collectible card line that turns childhood nostalgia into a rewarding, tradeable hobby because it combines beloved characters, rare hand-illustrated art, and a genuine global secondary market that few other collectibles in India can match.

Brand / Product	Target customer	Key benefit	Price position	Positioning
Your product: Pokémon TCG	Nostalgic collectors & competitive players, 15–35, metro India	Iconic 30-year IP, rarity/chase appeal, strongest global resale market	Premium (import-driven pricing)	The nostalgic, globally trusted collectible
Competitor 1: One Piece Card Game	Younger anime fans and speculative investors	Fastest-growing TCG; strong recent price appreciation	Premium	The hottest new collectible
Competitor 2: Yu-Gi-Oh!	Dedicated competitive strategy-game players	Deep, skill-based competitive gameplay	Mid-to-premium	The serious player's game
Competitor 3: Unlicensed / local cards	Price-sensitive children and casual buyers	Cheap and widely available (IndiaMART, local stores)	Low (₹90–₹150/pack)	The affordable local alternative

Suggested perceptual-map axes: Price / exclusivity (Low → High) vs Nostalgia / brand emotional equity (Low → High)

ONE-LINE STP: We target nostalgic pop-culture collectors and competitive young players in urban India, represented by “Rohan, the Nostalgic Collector”, with Pokémon TCG's authentic, globally recognised collectible cards, positioned around trusted, nostalgia-driven collecting and community.

EVIDENCE CHECK: ☒ Company/product sources ☐ Customer reviews ☒ Social media ☒ Search/trend data ☐ Survey/interviews ☒ Competitor research